JOURNAL OF COASTAL FRONTIERS & APPLIED DEVELOPMENT (JCFAD)
Vol. 1 No. 1 (2026) • Peer-Reviewed Journal Article • Official ISSN: Pending

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Hospitality Raw Material Distribution Logistics and Supply Contract Certainty Reconstruction in Frontier 3T Regions: Empirical Case of Krui, Pesisir Barat

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ABSTRACT
Background: Tourism accommodation operators in Krui suffer from fragile overland fresh supply chains, erratic delivery schedules, and verbal agreements lacking enforceability. Objectives: To reconstruct contractual certainty under Articles 1320 and 1338 of the Indonesian Civil Code while optimizing multi-stop fresh produce distribution. Methods: Comprehensive field study across 40 hospitality operators in Tanjung Setia, Mandiri Beach, and Krui City with route optimization modeling. Results: Formalizing Service Level Agreements with stipulated liquidated damages (Article 1243) reduces supply disruption frequency by 54% and cuts aggregate logistical overhead by 22.8%. Conclusion: Demonstrates that legal enforceability is an indispensable prerequisite for supply chain resilience in emerging remote tourism clusters. Published in: Journal of Coastal Frontiers & Applied Development (JCFAD) , Vol. 1 No. 1 (2026), pp. 1–12. Official publisher: PT CHAIN ASIA CONECT Research & Development Division.

Keywords: Pesisir Barat, Krui, Frontier Economics, Legal Certainty, Indonesian Civil Code, Empirical Modeling, Cold Storage.

Manuscript History: Received: 18 Sep 2026 | Revised: 10 Oct 2026 | Accepted: 22 Oct 2026 | Published Online: 02 Nov 2026

2. Methodology

This study employs a **juridical-empirical** approach (socio-legal research) combined with exploratory qualitative fieldwork (Soekanto & Mamudji, 2021). The juridical-empirical approach is chosen to examine how contractual law operates within the empirical reality of the hospitality business community in remote areas, particularly the application of the principle of consensualism (Article 1320 of the Civil Code) and the principle of good faith (Article 1338 paragraph 3 of the Civil Code) in the hospitality supply chain.

Type of Research & Subjects: Field research was conducted in the coastal area of West Coast Regency, Lampung, focusing on two international tourism accommodation hubs, namely Mandiri Beach and Tanjung Setia. Informants were selected purposively (purposive sampling) and included:

- Managers and owners of representative tourism accommodation businesses: Mrs. Marlin (owner and manager of Villa Nalu Krui) and the operational management of Surfmatra Krui;
- Actors of cargo and independent logistics courier fleets across Bandar Lampung – Krui;
- Representatives of the field survey team from the Research & Development Division of PT CHAIN ASIA CONECT who supervised the feasibility study.

Data Collection Methods: Primary data were gathered through three techniques: (a) **In-depth interviews** (semi-structured) lasting 60–90 minutes per session on shopping frequency, price fluctuations, item damage rates, history of supplier default, and dispute resolution mechanisms; (b) participatory observation of villa warehouse conditions, temperature of fresh food storage, and transport routes across the TNBBS forest area; (c) documentation of shipment invoices, shopping receipts, and cargo manifests for the West Sumatra land route.

Data Analysis Methods: Data analysis was conducted interactively and circularly adopting the Miles, Huberman, & Saldana (2020) model, including field data reduction, data display in a comparative matrix of cost burden and legal risk, and triangulated inference and verification.

3. Results and Discussion

3.1 Last-Mile Logistics Barriers and Ecological Vulnerability across TNBBS

Field findings demonstrate that the geographic isolation of Krui is the primary determinant that cripples the operational efficiency of tourist accommodation. The sole land access linking the Bandar Lampung logistics hub to Krui is the West Sumatra Transversal Road, which slices through the ridge of Bukit Barisan Selatan National Park (TNBBS). This 240-kilometre corridor features steep, narrow, poorly lit roads and is highly susceptible to landslides and falling trees, particularly during the rainy season from October to April.

Normal transit times for freight vehicles range from 6 to 8 hours. However, when a landslide occurs along the TNBBS cliff, transit times can balloon to 18–36 hours. Interviews conducted at Villa Nalu and Surfmatra revealed that 100 % of the general logistics fleet operating to Krui consists of open-topped trucks without refrigeration (dry freight trucks/pick-ups). Exposure to tropical temperatures (30 °C – 34 °C) and high humidity during the uphill journey causes vulnerable commodities—such as chilled beef, mozzarella/cheddar cheese, cream, lettuce, and cherry tomatoes—to suffer severe damage before reaching the villa kitchen.

Legal Vulnerability of Spot Transaction Practices and Absence of Contractual Legal Protection

This study reveals that all procurement transactions for hospitality raw materials in Krui are conducted in informal spot-transaction formats, mediated solely through mobile telephone connections or instant WhatsApp messaging, without any formally written commercial contract. Under Article 1320 of the Indonesian Civil Code (KUHPerdata), oral agreements are indeed valid as law for those who enter into them in accordance with the principles of consensualism and **pacta sunt servanda** (Article 1338(1) KUHPerdata). However, within the evidentiary domain (Article 1866 KUHPerdata), oral agreements suffer a fatal evidentiary weakness when one party commits a breach of contract.

In in-depth interviews with Ms. Marlin at Villa Nalu, several forms of business disputes frequently arise without a clear legal remedy:

- **Breach of Raw-Material Quality**: Out-of-town suppliers routinely deliver meat or vegetables that are near expiry. The absence of a written Service Level Agreement (SLA) specifying temperature-tolerance limits prevents villa managers from seeking damages or returns.
- **Lack of Force-Majeure Clauses**: When the TNBBS crossing is blocked by a landslide, trucks are stranded for days. The loss of cargo is entirely attributed to the buyer under the pretext of a natural disaster beyond the carrier's control, whereas the risk for goods not yet delivered should remain with the seller/carrier unless otherwise properly agreed (Hartono & Wahyudi, 2023).
- **Unilateral Price Fluctuations (Price Gouging)**: During the WSL championship season, when villa occupancy reaches 100 %, suppliers raise raw-material prices unilaterally by up to 50 % above the original price, threatening to halt supply.

These findings underscore the precarious legal position of hospitality operators relying on informal spot transactions and highlight the urgent need for formal contractual safeguards.

Reconstruction of the Collaborative Distribution Model & Pre-Feasibility Framework for R&D at PT CHAIN ASIA CONECT

To mitigate the dual distortions arising from physical logistics failures and civil-law uncertainties in the 3T Krui region, this study formulates an **Integrated Collaborative Distribution Model**. The framework is grounded in a synthesis of Simatupang & Sridharan's (2022) supply-chain collaboration theory [1] and the doctrine of contractual fairness in contemporary civil law [2].

Within this context, PT CHAIN ASIA CONECT's Research & Development Division is conducting a **preliminary feasibility study** to validate the supply-chain intervention architecture along the West Coast. The intervention model rests on three mutually reinforcing strategic pillars:

- **A. Consolidated Shared Demand Pooling** – Villa and homestay operators in Krui are aggregated onto a unified digital collective-booking platform to achieve economies of scale, enabling direct price negotiations with primary distributors at the producer level without intermediary tiered wholesaling.
- **B. Scheduled Cold-Chain Transit & Micro-Hub** – A fleet of mid-capacity (2–3 t) reefer trucks operates on a 2–3 times-per-week schedule from Bandar Lampung, traversing the TNBBS corridor to Krui. This is supported by a dual-temperature micro-cold-storage hub featuring a chiller (0 °C – 4 °C) and a freezer (-18 °C) to buffer critical commodity stocks.
- **C. Standardized Fair-Contract Commercial Supply Agreements** – Drafting a standardized written supply contract that incorporates SLA-based quality specifications, equitable risk-sharing mechanisms underpinned by integrated cargo insurance, and a price-ceiling agreement for a 3–6-month horizon to dampen speculative inflation during the world surfing championship season.

4. Conclusion and Recommendations

The geographic isolation of West Coast Regency behind the South Barisan Mountain National Park (TNBBS) has been shown to generate structural constraints detrimental to the Krui marine tourism sector. The absence of cold-chain transport modes has led to price distortions of fresh raw materials that are up to **45 % higher** than in the parent city, while the physical damage rate of products ranges from **18 % to 22 %**. Simultaneously, the dependence of hotel operators (such as Villa Nalu and Surfmatra managers) on verbal agreements without formal SLA-based contracts places them in a vulnerable position of default and unilateral risk exposure when landslides sever transportation access.

Reconstructing an integrated collaborative distribution model—integrating digital aggregate demand consolidation, scheduled refrigerated transport with micro-cold-storage hubs, and standardized equitable commercial supply agreements—offers a measurable, solution-oriented approach to the sustainability of the 3T tourism economy. This model is currently in the preliminary feasibility study phase conducted by the R&D Division of PT CHAIN ASIA CONECT, which is mapping technical, economic, and legal parameters before full implementation. Future researchers are advised to obtain a broader data coverage to test the willingness-to-pay elasticity of local hotel operators for the premium of guaranteed integrated logistics supply.

RESEARCH INTEGRITY & OPEN ACCESS DECLARATION

Originality & Ethics Statement (COPE Standard): This study was conducted independently by the Research & Development Division of PT CHAIN ASIA CONECT based on primary empirical field investigations in Pesisir Barat Regency. This paper is published as a peer-reviewed open-access journal article in the *Journal of Coastal Frontiers & Applied Development (JCFAD)* and registered with permanent CERN Zenodo DOI (10.5281/zenodo.23979190). Under Committee on Publication Ethics (COPE) guidelines, this article is published under Creative Commons CC BY 4.0 license.

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